

Solution Sheet 3— Stochastic Calculus

3.1: (a) By Itô's Lemma, if $Y_t = e^{\lambda t} X_t$, then

$$\begin{aligned} dY_t &= e^{\lambda t} \lambda (\mu - X_t) + e^{\lambda t} \sigma dW_t + \lambda e^{\lambda t} X_t dt \\ &= \lambda \mu e^{\lambda t} dt + \sigma e^{\lambda t} dW_t, \end{aligned}$$

so

$$Y_t = X_0 + \mu(e^{\lambda t} - 1) + \sigma \int_0^t e^{\lambda s} dW_s,$$

and

$$X_t = e^{\lambda t} X_0 + \mu(1 - e^{-\lambda t}) + \sigma e^{-\lambda t} \int_0^t e^{\lambda s} dW_s.$$

(b) We find the generating function of Y by considering $Z_t = e^{\eta Y_t}$. By Itô's Lemma,

$$\begin{aligned} dZ_t &= \eta Z_t dY_t + \frac{1}{2} \eta^2 Z_t d\langle Y \rangle_t \\ &= \left(\eta Z_t \lambda \mu e^{\lambda t} + \frac{1}{2} \eta^2 Z_t \sigma^2 e^{2\lambda t} \right) dt + \eta Z_t \sigma e^{\lambda t} dW_t. \end{aligned}$$

Then, provided $\mathbb{E} \left[\int_0^t Z_s^2 e^{2\lambda s} ds \right] < \infty$,

$$\begin{aligned} m(t) &= \mathbb{E}[Z_t] = \int_0^t \left(\eta \lambda \mu e^{\lambda s} + \frac{1}{2} \eta^2 \sigma^2 e^{2\lambda s} \right) m(s) ds \\ \implies \dot{m}(t) &= \left(\eta \lambda \mu e^{\lambda t} + \frac{1}{2} \eta^2 \sigma^2 e^{2\lambda t} \right) m(t) \\ \implies m(t) &= A \exp \left(\eta \mu (e^{\lambda t} - 1) + \frac{1}{2} \eta^2 \frac{\sigma^2}{2\lambda} (e^{2\lambda t} - 1) \right) \\ &= \exp \left(\eta (x_0 + \mu(e^{\lambda t} - 1)) + \frac{1}{2} \eta^2 \frac{\sigma^2}{2\lambda} (e^{2\lambda t} - 1) \right), \end{aligned}$$

since $m(0) = \mathbb{E}[e^{\eta x_0}]$. Then, we can see from the form of the generating function that

$$\begin{aligned} Y_t &\sim N \left(x_0 + \mu(e^{\lambda t} - 1), \frac{\sigma^2}{2\lambda} (e^{2\lambda t} - 1) \right) \\ \implies e^{-\lambda t} Y_t = X_t &\sim N \left(e^{-\lambda t} x_0 + \mu(1 - e^{-\lambda t}), \frac{\sigma^2}{2\lambda} (1 - e^{-2\lambda t}) \right). \end{aligned}$$

(c) We still have

$$m(t) = A \exp \left(\eta \mu (e^{\lambda t} - 1) + \frac{1}{2} \eta^2 \frac{\sigma^2}{2\lambda} (e^{2\lambda t} - 1) \right),$$

but now $Y_0 \sim N\left(\mu, \frac{\sigma^2}{2\lambda}\right)$ and so $m(0) = \mathbb{E}[e^{\eta Y_0}] = e^{\eta\mu + \frac{1}{2}\eta^2 \frac{\sigma^2}{2\lambda}}$. Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned} m(t) &= \exp\left(\eta\mu e^{\lambda t} + \frac{1}{2}\eta^2 \frac{\sigma^2}{2\lambda} e^{2\lambda t}\right) \\ \implies Y_t &\sim N\left(\mu e^{\lambda t}, \frac{\sigma^2}{2\lambda} e^{2\lambda t}\right) \\ \implies X_t &\sim N\left(\mu, \frac{\sigma^2}{2\lambda}\right), \end{aligned}$$

so X is stationary.

3.2: We work via induction, and we have shown the result for $n = 1, 2, 3$ in the previous sheet, so the base case is done. Suppose the result holds for some n . Then,

$$\int_{u_{n+1}=0}^t \int_{u_n=0}^{u_{n+1}} \cdots \int_{u_1=0}^{u_1} dW_{u_1} \cdots dW_{u_n} dW_{u_{n+1}} = \int_0^t \frac{u^{\frac{n}{2}}}{n!} h_n\left(\frac{W_u}{\sqrt{u}}\right) dW_u.$$

Now, by Itô's Lemma, if we let $Z_t = \frac{t^{\frac{n+1}{2}}}{(n+1)!} h_{n+1}\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right)$, then

$$\begin{aligned} dZ_t &= \frac{1}{2} \frac{t^{\frac{n-1}{2}}}{n!} h_{n+1}\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) dt - \frac{1}{2} \frac{t^{\frac{n-2}{2}}}{(n+1)!} W_t h'_{n+1}\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) dt \\ &\quad + \frac{t^{\frac{n}{2}}}{(n+1)!} h'_{n+1}\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) dW_t + \frac{1}{2} \frac{t^{\frac{n-1}{2}}}{(n+1)!} h''_{n+1}\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) dt \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \frac{t^{\frac{n-1}{2}}}{(n+1)!} \left[(n+1) h_{n+1}\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) - \frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}} h'_{n+1}\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) + h''_{n+1}\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) \right] dt \\ &\quad + \frac{t^{\frac{n}{2}}}{n!} h_n\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) dW_t \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \frac{t^{\frac{n-1}{2}}}{(n+1)!} \left[(n+1) h_{n+1}\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) - (n+1) \frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}} h_n\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) + n(n+1) h''_{n+1}\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) \right] dt \\ &\quad + \frac{t^{\frac{n}{2}}}{n!} h_n\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) dW_t \\ &= \frac{t^{\frac{n}{2}}}{n!} h_n\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) dW_t, \end{aligned}$$

using the given relations for Hermite polynomials. So then

$$Z_t = \frac{t^{\frac{n+1}{2}}}{(n+1)!} h_{n+1}\left(\frac{W_t}{\sqrt{t}}\right) = \int_0^t \frac{u^{\frac{n}{2}}}{n!} h_n\left(\frac{W_u}{\sqrt{u}}\right) dW_u,$$

which is exactly what we had above. Therefore, by induction, our result holds for all n .

3.3: (a) Let $X_t = (Y_t^1)^2 + (Y_t^2)^2$. Then, by Itô's Lemma,

$$\begin{aligned} dX_t &= 2Y_t^1 dY_t^2 + 2Y_t^2 dY_t^1 + \frac{1}{2}2 d\langle Y_t^2 \rangle + \frac{1}{2}2 d\langle Y_t^1 \rangle \\ &= 2Y_t^1 \left(-\frac{1}{2}Y_t^2 dt + Y_t^1 dW_t \right) + 2Y_t^2 \left(-\frac{1}{2}Y_t^1 dt - Y_t^2 dW_t \right) \\ &\quad + (Y_t^1)^2 dt + (Y_t^2)^2 dt \\ &= \left[-(Y_t^1)^2 + (Y_t^2)^2 - (Y_t^2)^2 + (Y_t^1)^2 \right] dt + [-2Y_t^1 Y_t^2 + 2Y_t^1 Y_t^2 - t] dW_t \\ &= 0, \end{aligned}$$

and so X_t is constant.

(b) Again by Itô's Lemma,

$$\begin{aligned} d(\cos(Z_t)) &= -\sin(Z_t) dZ_t - \frac{1}{2} \cos(Z_t) dt \\ d(\sin(Z_t)) &= \cos(Z_t) dZ_t - \frac{1}{2} \sin(Z_t) dt, \end{aligned}$$

so we can see that $Z_t = W_t$, a standard Brownian motion, will do.

(c) We can see that our process $\mathbf{Y}_t$ lies on the unit circle and its angle with the x -axis is given by Z_t , now a Brownian motion. If N_t is the winding number then we can write $N_t = \lfloor \frac{Z_t}{2\pi} \rfloor$, so

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{P}(N_t \geq n) &= \mathbb{P}\left(\left\lfloor \frac{Z_t}{2\pi} \right\rfloor \geq n\right) \\ &= \mathbb{P}\left(\frac{Z_t}{2\pi} \geq n\right) \\ &= \mathbb{P}(Z_t \geq 2n\pi) \\ &= \Phi\left(\frac{-2n\pi}{\sqrt{t}}\right), \end{aligned}$$

since $Z_t \sim N(0, t)$, where Φ is the c.d.f. of a standard normal r.v..

3.4: From the differential form we see that

$$X_t = x_0 + \int_0^t \mu X_s ds + \int_0^t \sigma X_s dW_s,$$

and so

$$m(t) = \mathbb{E}[X_t] = x_0 + \mu \int_0^t m(s) ds,$$

provided that we have $\mathbb{E}\left[\sigma^2 \int_0^t X_s^2 ds\right] < \infty$ (which can be shown). But then, differentiating, we get

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{m}(t) &= \mu m(t) \\ \implies m(t) &= A \exp(\mu t) \\ \implies m(t) &= x_0 \exp(\mu t). \end{aligned}$$

Taking limits gives

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} \mathbb{E}[X_t] = \infty, \quad \text{for } \alpha > 0.$$

We know, or it can be verified easily by Itô's Lemma, that

$$\begin{aligned} X_t &= x_0 \exp \left(\left(\mu - \frac{1}{2} \sigma^2 \right) t + \sigma W_t \right) \\ &= x_0 \exp \left(\sigma \left(W_t - \frac{1}{\sigma} \left(\frac{1}{2} \sigma^2 - \mu \right) t \right) \right) \\ &= x_0 \exp (\sigma (W_t - at)), \end{aligned}$$

for $a = \frac{1}{\sigma} \left(\frac{1}{2} \sigma^2 - \mu \right) > 0$ when $0 < \mu < \frac{\sigma^2}{2}$, so then we can see that

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} X_t = 0.$$

3.5: We can show that the given X_t satisfies the SDE, and then argue by uniqueness of solutions. By Itô's Lemma,

$$\begin{aligned} dX_t &= \left(y - x - \int_0^t \frac{dW_s}{1-s} \right) dt + dW_t \\ &= \frac{1}{1-t} \left(y - x - (y-x)t - (1-t) \int_0^t \frac{dW_s}{1-s} \right) dt + dW_t \\ &= \frac{y - X_t}{1-t} dt + dW_t, \end{aligned}$$

so the chosen X satisfies our SDE. We can argue using Theorem 5.5 that this must be the unique solution. To write our SDE in the form used in the theorem, we have $\mu(t, z) = \frac{y-z}{1-t}$, $\sigma(t, z) = 1$ and we suppose $t \in [0, T]$ where $T < 1$, so

$$\begin{aligned} |\mu(t, z)| + |\sigma(t, z)| &= 1 + \frac{|y-z|}{1-t} \\ &\leq 1 + \frac{|y|}{1-t} + \frac{|z|}{1-t} \\ &\leq \frac{1+|y|}{1-t} (1+|z|) \\ &\leq \frac{1+|y|}{1-T} (1+|z|). \end{aligned}$$

Similarly,

$$\begin{aligned} |\mu(t, z) + \mu(t, \tilde{z})| + |\sigma(t, z) + \sigma(t, \tilde{z})| &= \frac{|y-z-(y-\tilde{z})|}{1-t} \\ &= \frac{|z-\tilde{z}|}{1-t} \\ &\leq \frac{|z-\tilde{z}|}{1-T}, \end{aligned}$$

and so we satisfy the conditions required in Theorem 5.5. The theorem then tells us that our SDE has a unique solution for each $T < 1$, and so this unique solution

must be X given as above. Moreover, this is independent of T , so we can define this to be the solution for all $t < 1$. Now, we have that since $\mathbb{E} \left[\int_0^t \frac{ds}{(1-s)^2} \right] < \infty$, our stochastic integral term is a martingale, and in particular, $\mathbb{E} \left[\int_0^t \frac{dW_s}{1-s} \right] = 0$. Then we find that, by the Itô Isometry,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E} [(X_t - y)^2] &= (1-t)^2(x-y)^2 + (1-t)^2 \mathbb{E} \left[\int_0^t \frac{ds}{(1-s)^2} \right] \\ &= (1-t)^2(x-y)^2 + (1-t)^2 \left(\frac{1}{1-t} - 1 \right) \\ &\rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } t \rightarrow 1, \end{aligned}$$

and so $X_t \rightarrow y$ in $\mathcal{L}^2(\mathbb{P})$ as $t \rightarrow 1$.

3.6: We have $F_t = \exp \{-\alpha B_t + \frac{1}{2}\alpha^2 t\}$, so $F_t = f(t, B_t)$ where $f(t, x) = e^{-\alpha x + \alpha^2 t/2}$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} &= -\alpha f(t, x) \\ \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x^2} &= \alpha^2 f(t, x) \\ \frac{\partial f}{\partial t} &= \frac{1}{2}\alpha^2 f(t, x) \end{aligned}$$

Hence

$$\begin{aligned} df(t, B_t) &= -\alpha f(t, B_t) dB_t + \left(\frac{1}{2}\alpha^2 f(t, B_t) + \frac{1}{2}\alpha^2 f(t, B_t) \right) dt \\ &= -\alpha F_t dB_t + \alpha^2 F_t dt. \end{aligned}$$

Then

$$\begin{aligned} d(X_t F_t) &= F_t dX_t + X_t dF_t + dF_t dX_t \\ &= F_t \alpha X_t dB_t + F_t r dt - \alpha F_t X_t dB_t + \alpha^2 F_t X_t dt \\ &\quad + (-\alpha F_t dB_t + \alpha^2 F_t dt) (\alpha X_t dB_t + r dt) \\ &= (\alpha F_t X_t - \alpha F_t X_t) dB_t + (r F_t + \alpha^2 F_t X_t - \alpha^2 F_t X_t) dt \\ &= r F_t dt. \end{aligned}$$

Here we used $(dt)^2 = dB_t dt = 0$ between the second and third lines.

In particular, we have shown that $dY_t = r \exp \{-\alpha B_t + \frac{1}{2}\alpha^2 t\} dt$.

It follows that

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^t d(X_s F_s) &= F_t X_t - X_0 F_0 \\ \implies F_t X_t - X_0 F_0 &= \int_0^t r F_s ds \\ &= r \int_0^t \exp \left\{ -\alpha B_s + \frac{1}{2}\alpha^2 s \right\} ds \\ \implies X_t e^{-\alpha B_t + \alpha^2 t/2} &= x_0 e^0 + r \int_0^t \exp \left\{ -\alpha B_s + \frac{1}{2}\alpha^2 s \right\} ds \\ \implies X_t &= x_0 e^{\alpha B_t - \alpha^2 t/2} + r \int_0^t \exp \left\{ \alpha(B_t - B_s) - \frac{1}{2}\alpha^2(t-s) \right\} ds. \end{aligned}$$

3.7: We wish to use Itô's Lemma on $R_t = f(W_t^1, \dots, W_t^n)$ with $f(x_1, \dots, x_n) = (x_1^2 + \dots + x_n^2)^{\frac{1}{2}}$, so

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i} &= \frac{x_i}{(x_1^2 + \dots + x_n^2)^{\frac{1}{2}}} \\ \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_i^2} &= \frac{1}{(x_1^2 + \dots + x_n^2)^{\frac{1}{2}}} \left(1 - \frac{x_i^2}{(x_1^2 + \dots + x_n^2)^{\frac{3}{2}}} \right),\end{aligned}$$

and then,

$$\begin{aligned}dR_t &= \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{W_t^i dW_t^i}{R_t} + \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{1}{2} \frac{1}{R_t} \left(1 - \frac{(W_t^i)^2}{\sum_i (W_t^i)^2} \right) dt \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{W_t^i dW_t^i}{R_t} + \frac{1}{2} \frac{1}{R_t} \left(1 - \frac{\sum_i (W_t^i)^2}{\sum_i (W_t^i)^2} \right) dt \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{W_t^i dW_t^i}{R_t} + \frac{n-1}{2R_t} dt.\end{aligned}$$

Note now that $d\langle R \rangle_t = (dR_t)^2 = \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{(W_t^i)^2}{R_t^2} dt = dt$. Then, for $n = 2$, by Itô's Lemma again,

$$\begin{aligned}d(\ln(R_t)) &= \frac{dR_t}{R_t} - \frac{d\langle R \rangle_t}{2R_t^2} \\ &= \frac{W_t^1 dW_t^1}{R_t^2} + \frac{W_t^2 dW_t^2}{R_t^2} + \frac{1}{2R_t} dt - \frac{dt}{2R_t^2} \\ &= \frac{W_t^1 dW_t^1 + W_t^2 dW_t^2}{R_t^2}.\end{aligned}$$

Similarly, for $n \geq 3$,

$$\begin{aligned}d(R_t^{2-n}) &= (2-n)R_t^{1-n} dR_t + \frac{1}{2}(2-n)(1-n)R_t^{-n} d\langle R \rangle_t \\ &= (2-n)R_t^{-n} \sum_{i=1}^n W_t^i dW_t^i + \frac{1}{2}(2-n)(n-1)R_t^{-n} dt + \frac{1}{2}(2-n)(1-n)R_t^{-n} dt \\ &= (2-n)R_t^{-n} \sum_{i=1}^n W_t^i dW_t^i.\end{aligned}$$

3.8: Note that for $t < \infty$ we have

$$I_t^N = \int_0^t \varphi_u^N dW_u = \begin{cases} N, & \text{if } H_{-1,N} < t, W_{H_{-1,N}} = N \\ -1, & \text{if } H_{-1,N} < t, W_{H_{-1,N}} = -1 \\ W_t, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

But it can be shown, for example by using the fact that $\limsup_t |W_t| = \infty$ almost surely, that as we let our time run to infinity, our Brownian Motion W almost surely hits -1 or N , or $\mathbb{P}(W_t \in (-1, N) \forall t \in [0, \infty)) = 0$. So then,

$$I^N = \int_0^\infty \varphi_u^N dW_u = \lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} \int_0^t \varphi_u^N dW_u = \begin{cases} N, & \text{if } W_{H_{-1,N}} = N \\ -1, & \text{if } W_{H_{-1,N}} = -1. \end{cases}$$

Since, as mentioned above, $H_{-1,N} < \infty$ almost surely, we have that $\mathbb{E}[I^N] = 0$, and by continuity of Brownian paths, $W_{H_{-1,N}} \in \{-1, N\}$ almost surely. Then we can write this as

$$\begin{aligned} 0 = \mathbb{E}[I^N] &= -\mathbb{P}(W_{H_{-1,N}} = -1) + N\mathbb{P}(W_{H_{-1,N}} = N) \\ \implies \mathbb{P}(W_{H_{-1,N}} = N) &= \frac{1}{N}\mathbb{P}(W_{H_{-1,N}} = -1). \end{aligned}$$

But also, $\mathbb{P}(W_{H_{-1,N}} = N) + \mathbb{P}(W_{H_{-1,N}} = -1) = 1$, and so we can solve to find that

$$\mathbb{P}(W_{H_{-1,N}} = N) = \frac{1}{1+N} \quad \mathbb{P}(W_{H_{-1,N}} = -1) = \frac{N}{1+N}.$$

Then, for $\varepsilon > 0$, since $W_{H_{-1}} = -1$ almost surely,

$$\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \mathbb{P}(|W_{H_{-1,N}} - W_{H_{-1}}| > \varepsilon) = \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \mathbb{P}(W_{H_{-1,N}} = N) = 0,$$

so $I^N \rightarrow I = -1$ in probability. Clearly then $\mathbb{E}[I] = -1$, and we can see that

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[(I^N - I)^2] &= 0\mathbb{P}(W_{H_{-1,N}} = -1) + (N+1)^2\mathbb{P}(W_{H_{-1,N}} = N) \\ &= N+1 \\ &\rightarrow \infty \quad \text{as } N \rightarrow \infty, \end{aligned}$$

so we do not have convergence in $\mathcal{L}^2(\mathbb{P})$.